

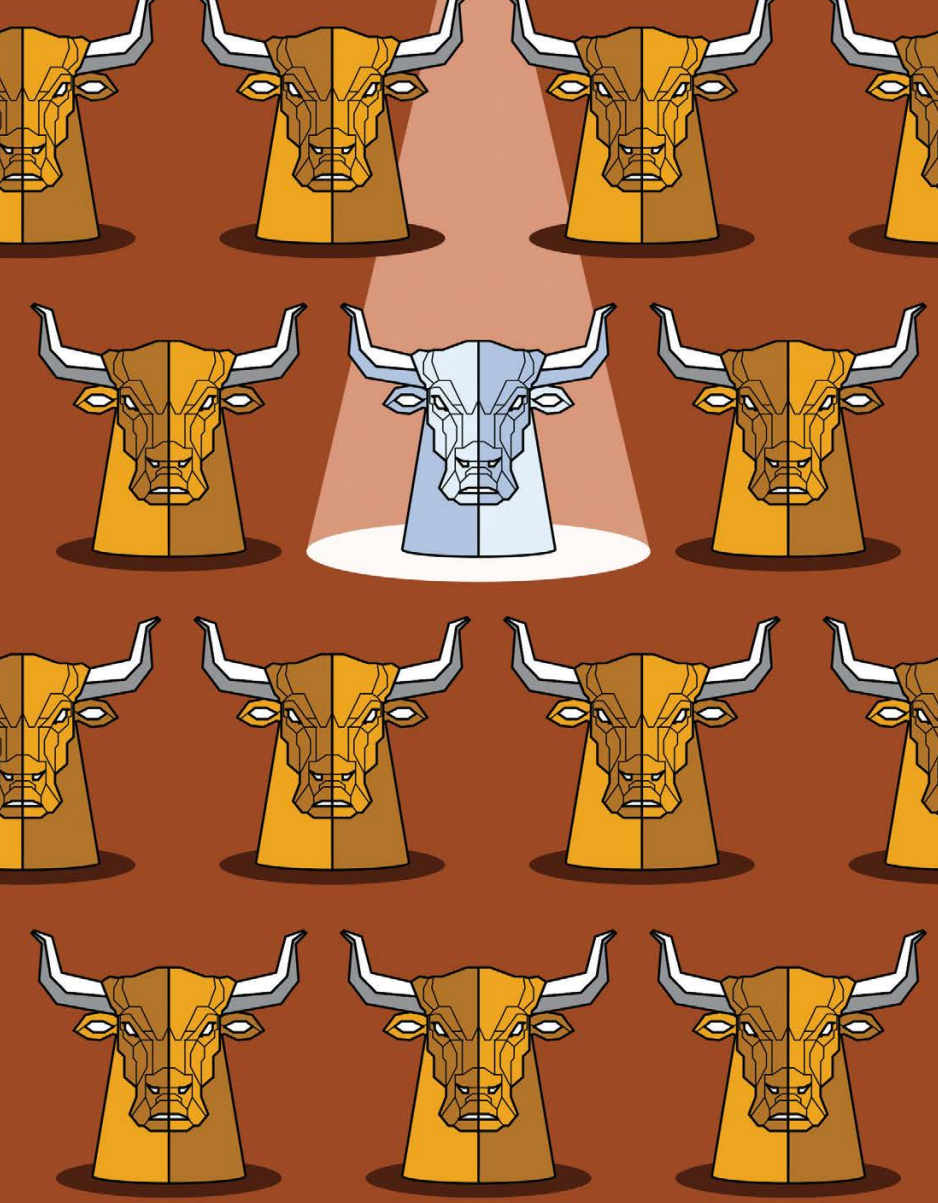


ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**

genres. A fan of *Harry Potter* and *Avengers*, Shanghvi, well into his sixties, preferred adventure sports on vacations with the same friends he started Sun with.

Finally, the Ranbaxy leader lost the ten-year bet to me in letter but won it in spirit. True to his style, Shanghvi opted for the less obvious route to emerge as a global pharma major. Through his \$11.75-billion acquisition of US-based Organon—India's second-largest overseas takeover—Sun has demonstrated it is no longer content with more scale in generics. "I learn from personalities and companies, what to do, and what not to do," he told me. It seems he learned from Teva what not to do—overdependence on commoditised generics and debt stress from mega M&As. So it's no surprise that though Teva continues to be the largest generic behemoth globally with three

INSTEAD OF CELEBRATING HIS LEAP TO THE TOP OF THE RICH LISTS, HE WAS UNCOMFORTABLE BEING FAMOUS. IN THE AGE OF INSTANT GRATIFICATION, SHANGHVI STOOD FOR A MARATHON APPROACH

times Sun's revenue (ex-Organon), Sun's market capitalisation is worth more than Teva's. Through this acquisition, Sun has shifted its league from an Indian company with a global footprint to a global company headquartered in India. Shanghvi is already changing how In-

dian Pharma sees itself—proving that they can compete globally not only on cost, but on scale, complexity, and strategic ambition.

If the Organon execution goes well, it may well be the culmination of the 'unfinished agenda' of two of his predecessors—Parvinder Singh of Ranbaxy, who dreamt of a truly global pharma giant of Indian origin, and Anji Reddy of Dr Reddy's, who dreamt of an innovative drug from India.

Granted enough time, Shanghvi may script the next chapter in Indian pharma—from imitation to innovation. And for this patient marathon strategist, preparations for that leap began at least a decade and a half back. **BT**

*The author is a former business journalist and author of *The Reluctant Billionaire: How Dilip Shanghvi became the Richest Self-Made Indian*. Views are personal*